- *Access Token*—This represents the authorization given to the OAuth2 Client to access protected data provided by an OAuth2 Resource Server on the user's behalf.

In Edge Service, Spring Security uses the ID Token to extract information about the authenticated user, set up a context for the current user session, and make the data available through the `OidcUser` object. That's what you saw in the previous chapter.

The Access Token grants Edge Service authorized access to Catalog Service and Order Service (the OAuth2 Resource Servers) on behalf of the user. After we secure both applications, Edge Service will have to include the Access Token in all requests routed to them as an `Authorization` HTTP header. Unlike ID Tokens, Edge Service doesn't read the Access Token's content because it's not the intended audience. It stores the Access Token received from Keycloak and then includes it as-is in any request to a protected endpoint downstream.

This pattern is called *token relay*, and it's supported by Spring Cloud Gateway as a built-in filter, so you don't need to implement anything yourself. When the filter is enabled, the Access Token is included automatically in all requests sent to one of the downstream applications. Figure 12.2 illustrates how the token relay pattern works.